

BLACK, WHITE, AND RED CURRANTS

Ribes nigrum and *R. rubrum*

Delicious used in desserts, pies, or jams, these beautiful berries are an eye-catching addition to any garden. Currants are fully hardy, very tough, and tolerant of most soil types, although black currants prefer a more fertile soil, and more direct sunlight than red and white varieties.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING

Ensure that you buy certified one- or two-year-old disease-free plants, and ensure that container-grown plants have not become pot-bound. These can be planted at any time of year, as long as you give them enough water, but bare-root types should be planted in late fall or early spring.

Bushes can become quite large, so make sure that you give them enough space—about 5 ft (1.5 m) between plants. White and red currants can also be trained into cordons or fans, requiring less ground space. All currants are self-fertile, so will fruit with only one plant.

Dig in well-rotted manure or compost just before planting, and site in a sheltered, frost-free spot.



Mulch the currant bushes in early spring.

Remove any weeds and, if necessary, double-dig the site to improve the drainage. Black currant plants need to be planted 2 in (5 cm) lower than they were in their original pot, to encourage the plant to produce strong new stems. All currants have relatively shallow roots so can be planted in containers, if need be, and then moved under cover in colder months.